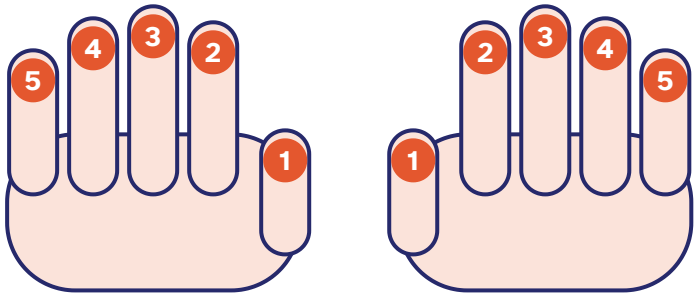
BEFORE THE SONGS

Getting ready

Three pages to do before Lesson 1, at the piano and away from it: your hands, how to sit, the keyboard's own map, and a warm-up for fingers 2, 3 and 4.

1 Your fingers have numbers

Thumbs are 1 and little fingers are 5, in both hands. Pianists use the numbers to say which finger plays.



LEFT HAND RIGHT HAND

Number game. Your teacher calls a number; wiggle that finger on both hands. Then thumbs tap together, then the 3s, then the 5s: your hands are mirrors.

☐ **Wiggled 1 to 5, each hand** ☐ **Tapped the mirror fingers together**

Draw around your right hand here, then write 1 to 5 on the fingertips.

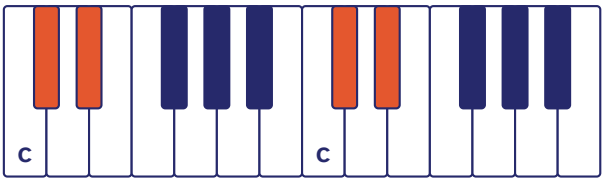
2 Sit like a pianist

Check each one at the start of every practice.

- [ ] **On the front half of the bench**
- [ ] **Feet flat on the floor (or on a box)**
- [ ] **Elbows a little in front of you, level with the keys**
- [ ] **Round hands, as if holding a small ball**

3 The keyboard's map

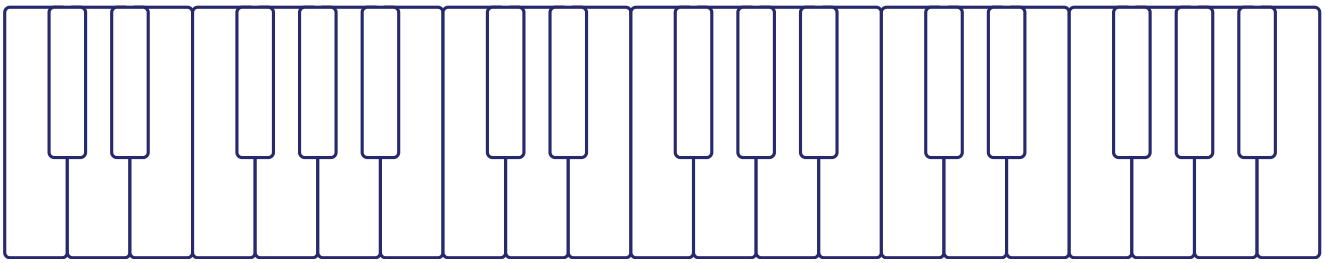
The black keys come in twos and threes, all the way along. They are how you find every white key.



Twos and threes. Play every group of two black keys from the bottom to the top, then every group of three.
Find C. C is the white key just left of each two. Play every C.

Low and high. Left is low, right is high: the turtle walks down low, the bird flies up high. Play a turtle note, then a bird note.

Colour the map. Colour every two black keys one colour and every three another, then write C under every C.



- [ ] **Played all the twos and threes**
- [ ] **Found every C**
- [ ] **Low and high**
- [ ] **Coloured the map**

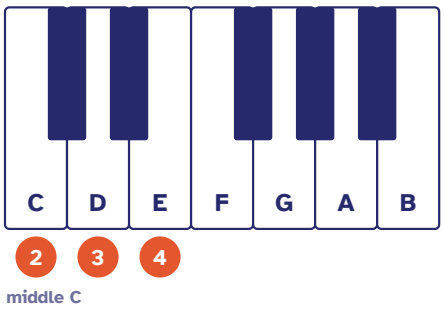
4 Warm up fingers 2, 3 and 4

Lesson 1 is played by the three middle fingers. Wake them up: first tapping on the closed lid, then on the keys. Right hand, then left hand: the numbers are the same in both.

ON THE LID · TAP AND SAY THE NUMBERS

Two fingers	2	3	2	3	2	3	2	3
Three fingers	2	3	4	3	2	3	4	3
Twice each	2	2	3	3	4	4	3	3

ON THE KEYS · C D E



Right hand: 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 4 on C, 3 on D, 2 on E.

Up and down	2	3	4		4	3	2	
Down, down	4	3	2		4	3	2	

Echo. Your teacher plays three notes with fingers 2, 3 and 4; play them back. Then you play three and your teacher copies you.

- ☐ **Tapped 2 3 on the lid**
- ☐ **Tapped 2 3 4 on the lid**
- ☐ **Played 2 3 4 on the keys**
- ☐ **Played the echo game**